

ANIME

The God of High School

★★★★☆ | The God of High School was already a pretty popular webtoon before Crunchyroll came around and teamed up with them to bring us another one of their “Crunchyroll Originals”.

Now, the webtoon is fairly popular, and we know people who have read it and are big fans. However, we personally haven't read the webtoon. Having said that, we're of the opinion that the anime adaption lacks substance, among other things. If this has to do with the source material or not, we don't actually know, so we can't really comment. The story progression and world-building are a chaotic mess. What starts off as a “God of



High School tournament” to crown the strongest fighters in “high school” ends up becoming well... we're not quite sure what it ends up becoming.

First of all, it really shouldn't be called The God of High School, half

the participants shouldn't even be in high school to begin with. What starts off as an MMA tournament soon turns into a superpowered free-for-all, and suddenly fighters are using something called charyeok (“borrowed power”) and firing kamehameha's everywhere. The pacing is fast, too fast, and they're constantly throwing new characters at you, so it's hard to keep track.

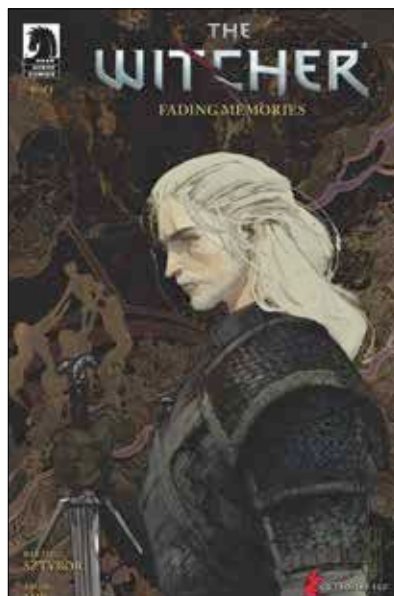
They also make sure to cram in a flashback or two into each episode to try and make the newly appearing characters more relevant. The only good thing God of High School has going for it is its animation. They probably decided if it looks good people probably won't mind the rest.

The fighting animations are cool and fluid, and all that. But ultimately, the show lacks originality, both with its plot and the characters, who seem to conveniently fall under every existing shounen trope.

COMIC

The Witcher: Fading Memories

★★★★☆ | As soon as you look at the cover, you know this is going to be good. We have reviewed the Elric comics before, and if you are a fan of the long history of comics based on the works of Moorcock, you know you are in for a treat. The similarity between Geralt and Elric is particularly striking in comic book form. Both Geralt and Elric are experienced swordsmen, albinos with freaky eyes known as the white wolf and are in continued conflict with supernatural forces. Sapkowski has clarified that these superficial similarities are incidental. While it is easy to imagine The Witcher to be yet another version of The Eternal Champion within the multiverse, in the few pages of the



first volume of this new series, Geralt does manage to establish himself as a character in his own right. This is done by revealing a complex internal monologue, where The Witcher is talking to himself and trying to find an explanation for a big mystery. The Witcher is out of work and low on

coin, because all the monsters that he was supposed to hunt, that form his bread and butter, have suddenly disappeared. He somehow manages to bag a token quest, but then easily kills the monsters who speak in the human tongue, leading him to realise that the whole thing is an illusion. Without even knowing it, The Witcher seems to be losing where both the players and the game are unknown. This is just the first volume of what seems like a promising new series, and as such is little more than an introduction.

There are some panels that are very similar to certain cutscenes in Witcher 3, and there are many familiar locations as well as cutscenes. The cover is really gorgeous, but the rest of the artwork in the book is just consistently good. There are new awesome panels that stand out though. A very limited muted palette of dark orange, dark blue and dark violet is used, which manages to evoke a sense of despair and loss, which is very suitable for the story. Just put this one down on your reading list and binge read it after a few issues are out.